IBM i2 Connect

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Product Overview

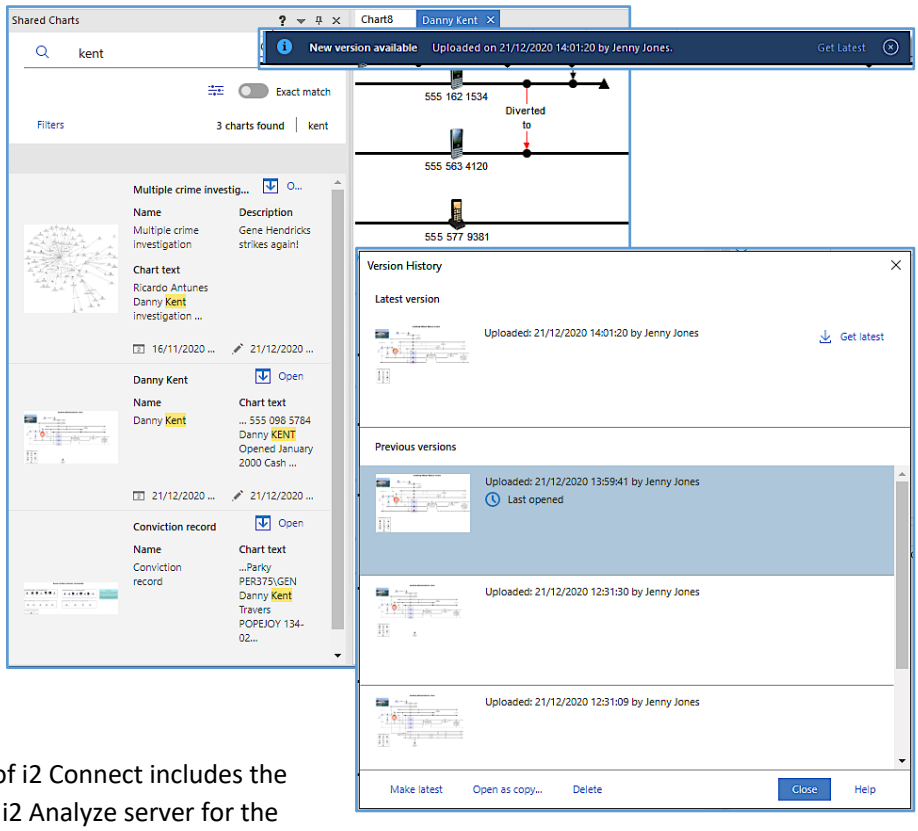
IBM i2 Connect helps enable users to quickly and easily connect to multiple data sources to collate, analyse, and visualize data, helping to reduce the time required to discover key information in large volumes of data. By offering search, data aggregation, and extensive analysis and visualization capabilities, i2 Connect delivers a host of benefits.

- Streamlining data processing and reducing manual tasks.
- Fast discovery of hidden connections and patterns in complex data, helping to identify, predict, prevent, and disrupt criminal, cyber, and fraudulent activities.
- Targeted searching directly over source data to quickly augment and enrich investigations, analysis, and intelligence production.
- Supporting interoperability by integrating with third-party software.

New Features

Analyst's Notebook Premium Chart store

Analyst's Notebook Premium as part of i2 Connect can now be installed with its own shared chart store.



Storing charts in the chart store facilitates collaborative working; allowing multiple users to work with, contribute to, and enrich charts. A version history of all stored charts is maintained providing the ability to view or revert to previous versions of a stored chart for analytical or error correction purposes.

Both automated and interactive version checks in Analyst's Notebook Premium ensure that Analysts are always working with the most current version of the chart.

Analyst's Notebook Premium as part of i2 Connect includes the components required to configure an i2 Analyze server for the Chart Store, including a restricted use version of IBM DB2.

The i2 Analyze server as part of i2 Connect is only licensed for use with i2 Connect and as a Chart Store.

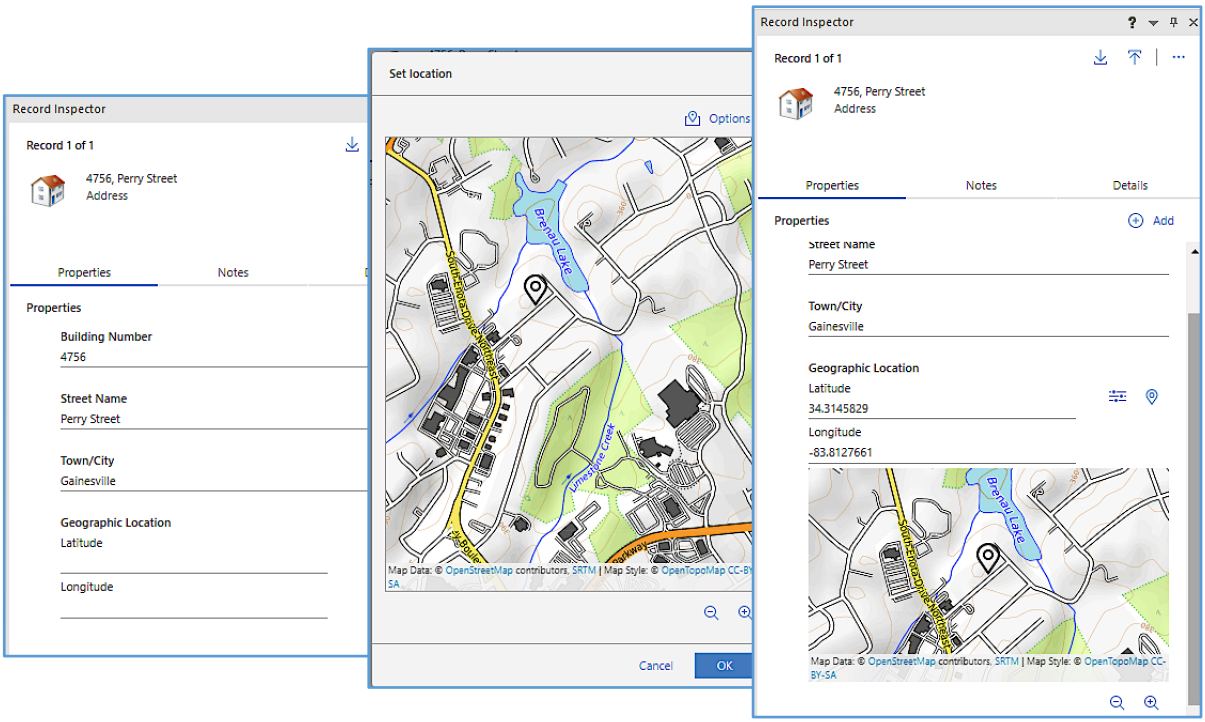
Combine matching i2 Analyze records on paste

When Analyst's Notebook Premium copies and pastes i2 Analyze records between charts it resolves matches between the records copied from the source chart and records already present in the target chart; to limit data duplication and chart clutter. When matches are found, Analyst's Notebook Premium determines the best way to combine or unite the source and target records based on the type of record.

Record matching when copying and pasting is based on the record identifiers, source identifiers, and any system match rules that have been configured.

Manual geocode

The Analyst's Notebook Premium record inspector allows a user to manually position a geo-enabled record at its approximate location on the record inspector mini map in order to provide coordinates for the record. An analyst can now easily provide coordinates for a record that they know the location of either through local knowledge or descriptive information.



Flexible schemas

Analyst's Notebook Premium provides flexible schema support with i2 Connect, facilitating the charting and analysis of search results from connectors with different schemas. In previous versions all connectors were required to use the same i2 Analyze schema (or a schema fragment). This change makes the creation and deployment of connectors easier and more flexible.

Records from i2 Connect can now be charted as i2 Analyze records using the individual connectors schema. These "unaligned" records can be used with Analyst's Notebook features including conditional formatting, live formatting, and find matching records.

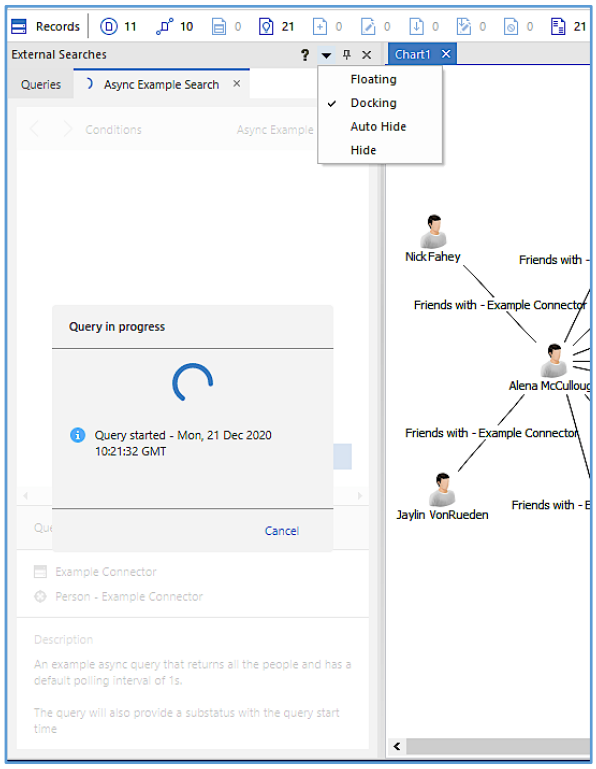
A system administrator can optionally configure item type conversion between the different connector schemas to provide a consistent chart schema, reducing chart complexity, and to allow record matching to occur across aligned item types.

i2 Analyze type conversion console

i2 Connect provides an i2 Analyze type conversion console for administrators to assist with schema item type conversion. This interactive tool can be used to map the conversion of item types and properties from a connector schema to one or more gateway.

Once schemas have been aligned to a common schema, analysts benefit from a consistent chart schema, reduced chart complexity, and record matching across aligned item types.

Asynchronous searches



i2 Connect external searches that do not return results quickly, either due to the volume of results or poor performance of the data source can be setup by an administrator to run asynchronously. Once started, these asynchronous searches continue to run on the server allowing the user to return at a later time to view the results, even if they have disconnected from the i2 Analyze server.

i2 Connect can display status messages in Analyst's Notebook Premium to indicate the current state of a long running search, for example to indicate when the search was started, that a search is still running, or that the search has failed. The messages displayed are configured by an administrator when developing the connector for an external data source.

Analyst's Notebook Premium – other new features and changes

- i2 Connect external searches from Analyst's Notebook Premium now support geospatial point conditions.
- The Analyst's Notebook Premium Shared Charts and External Search tools are now dockable to provide a flexible analysis desktop to suit both single and multiple screen workspaces.

i2 Connect Pre-requisites

i2 Connect

- IBM i2 Analyze 4.3.3 (included)
- IBM i2 Analyst's Notebook Premium 9.2.3 (included)
- IBM Db2 Standard Edition 11.5 (included) or Microsoft SQL Server 2017, 2019 (not included)
- WebSphere Liberty 20.0.0.3 (included)

i2 Analyst's Notebook Premium

- Microsoft .NET Framework 4.7.2 and Microsoft .NET Framework 3.5 SP1
- Esri ArcGIS Server 10 with Portal for ArcGIS (optional, for i2 Esri Maps)
- Map tile server (optional for i2 Maps)

i2 Connect Hardware requirements

i2 Connect

- A minimum of 4 GB total disk space is recommended for installation of the i2 Analyst's Notebook Premium Chart Store based on following minimum requirements:
  - 1 GB free disk space for installation for i2 Analyze
  - 2 GB free disk space for installation for WebSphere Application Server
  - 1 GB free disk space for installation for IBM DB2 standard edition
- In addition to these minimum requirements additional disk space will be required for data storage.

- In a production environment, a minimum of 16 GB of RAM is required for the application server and 8 GB of RAM is required for the i2 Analyze JVM.
    - The recommended amount of memory is 32 GB for the application server and 16 GB for the i2 Analyze JVM.
- Minimum processor specification 2 Ghz dual-core.

Analyst's Notebook Premium

- Minimum of 2 GB free disk space for installation. Total disk space requirements depend on the planned size of the repository. An average Local Analysis Repository will use 150 GB of space.
- Minimum of XGA-capable graphics card (1152 x 864 high colour (16 bit)), and colour monitor – an SXGA-capable graphics card (1280 x1024 high colour (16 bit)) and colour monitor is recommended.
- Minimum of 4GB RAM – at least 8GB RAM is recommended.
- Minimum processor specification 2 Ghz quad-core.

Companion Software

- Microsoft Office 2016, 2019 and 365 Enterprise (64 bit versions are not supported)

Languages

LANGUAGES	ANBP 9.2.3
English	✓ *
French	✓ *
German	✓ *
Italian	✓ *
Spanish	✓ *
Japanese	✓
Brazilian Portuguese	✓ *
Simplified Chinese	✓
Traditional Chinese	✓
Korean	✓
Russian	✓
Turkish	✓
Arabic	✓ *
Hebrew	✓ *

* Shared Charts and External Searches, as well as the chart store are supported for these languages only.

Operating System Support

i2 Connect

- Microsoft Windows Server 2012 R2
- Microsoft Windows Server 2016
- Microsoft Windows Server 2019
- Red Enterprise Linux (RHEL) Workstation 6
- Red Enterprise Linux (RHEL) Workstation 7

Analyst's Notebook Premium

- Microsoft Windows 10 Pro, and Enterprise
- Windows Server 2012 R2 Essentials, Standard, and Datacenter
- Windows Server 2016 Essentials, Standard, and Datacenter
- Windows Server 2019 Essentials, Standard, and Datacenter

This, and future releases of i2 Analyst's Notebook Premium are only supported on the latest update or service pack for each supported Microsoft Windows version as listed at **http://windows.microsoft.com/en-gb/windows/lifecycle**